At this stage, you will have clearly defined responsibilities and accountability for different aspects of your data assets, from adherence to regulatory requirements, to data ownership, to monitoring of data-quality metrics. When describing the central governance model, we warned about bottlenecks and overhead resulting from the communication requirements. Federated governance may remove some of this burden, but if done manually, the number of repetitive tasks laid on the central governance body may still result in a significant slowdown of operations. The next step in unclogging the development pipeline is automating repetitive governance tasks, making data governance computational.

6.5 Making data governance computational

This section explains what *computational* means and why making data governance computational is necessary from the very beginning of your journey.

Making governance policies entirely computational requires two steps. Step 1 is to convert the policy into a form that can be automated, and step 2 is to automate the execution. In step 2, it is not necessary to automate everything. Instead, you can choose a level of automation that fits your current level of data maturity and slowly increase that by repeating these two steps from time to time. By *computational*, the data mesh paradigm describes the automatic testing or execution of data governance rules.

Our starting point is an understanding of our policies, which we should now have in a written form. They could read, for instance, as follows:

- No personalized information is allowed to be shared without strict access control.
- All data should contain metadata that identifies its business domain.

The first policy is meant to help implement privacy regulations. In contrast, the second one aims to make data more FAIR by using the company’s pool of ubiquitous language for business domains.